

its striking scenery, Gwynedd claims not only the snow-covered Snowdonia Range, but also the Cambrian Mountains to the south. It contains many popular coastal towns, such as Bangor and Conwy, as well as smaller inland towns, such as Dolgellau and Llandudno, tucked away in the valleys. The closest to a “prince” that Gwynedd has is the ancient boggan Gwilym Pugh, last in the line of commoner seneschals of Cymru’s last high king. He desperately clings to life and his fae seeming as he waits for a successor. Sadly, his choice, his daughter Susan, is Kinain rather than Kithain.

Principality of Powys

Now lost to Banality, the Principality of Powys occupies central Cymru, from Cardigan Bay in the west to the Kingdom of Albion in the east. The trod called Gwyddno’s Track, said to lead at one time to all the cantreys (or provinces) in Cymru as well as to Hibernia, now lies lost somewhere within Powys. A place of few towns, Powys contains a few spectacular spas and resorts. It also has the lowest human population in Wales and no known fae. At one time, a ghille dhu named Vaughn Davies watched over the realm from a distance, afraid to interact with the outside world and lose himself to Banality. Presently, none know if he has a successor.

Principality of Dyfed

Known as The Land of Seas and Shores, the Principality of Dyfed occupies a peninsula, with Cardigan Bay, the Bristol Channel, and St. George’s Channel surrounding it on three sides. Prince Dylan ap Gwynedd rules Dyfed, though he tends to avoid making decisions. He believes himself cursed to ruin the land of Cymru should he attempt to rule as High King, a conviction that has tainted his self-confidence in his own ability to rule at all. Prince Dylan rules from his manor home, Dinas Cleddau, only a few hundred feet from the sea. Outwardly a whitewashed cottage, the inside combines the modernity of a fine manor with the prince’s passion for sea life, as befits his mortal position as a marine biologist.

Principality of Glamorgan

The Land of Black Rowan, the lost Principality of Glamorgan consists of south central Cymru. Once one of the most pristine spots in Cymru, the land now holds many noteworthy (in mortal terms) cities: Cardiff, Newport, Caerphilly, Pontiprid, and Rhondda. The land is ruled by Lloyd Morgenstern, a former nocker hero who, long ago, suffered a curse that transformed him into one of the Dauntain in all his successive lives. Now he dedicates himself to the eradication of Glamour in his bailiwick.

Principality of Gwent

Gwent, the Borderland, lies south of the Principality of Powys and northeast of the Principality of Glamorgan. Like Clwd and Powys, it shares a border with the Kingdom of Albion. Gwent includes the towns of Monmouth, Usk, Chepstow, and

Abergavenny. Known for its rich farmland, the region also contains important historical locations, among them the Roman excavations at Caerleon, and Tintern Abbey, immortalized by Wordsworth’s poem. The satyr grump and former actor Nestor Evans and his pooka friend Derwyn ap Allyn have been the most influential changelings in the realm. Both are on the verge of losing their fae seemings forever, and now search for worthy successors.

Neustria (France)

The land of Neustria serves as a stronghold for the dominion of the sidhe in Europe. With a four to one ratio of nobles to commoners, most of the sidhe favor the old feudal system and a monarchic government. The ruling sidhe consider commoners without an oath of fealty to link them to a noble as suspect, perhaps even anarchists. Neustria is ruled by Queen Margarete of House Gwydion, along with her consort Prince Eugene of House Beaumayn.

The Duchy of Bayeaux

The provinces of northern France fall under the rule of the Conte Hillaire du Lille, of House Eiluned. He values power above all and has lately been courting some of the sidhe of House Beaumayn, one of the late-arriving houses, in an effort to draw approval from his queen.

The Duchy of Burgundy

Comprising the provinces that make up the South of France, with the exception of the independent Aquitaine, Lord Guy de Cheval of House Gwydion rules his realm with strictness and an attention to detail. Commoners who do not hold to the many forms of etiquette he deems necessary meet penalties as light as a donation of dross and as harsh as exile.

The Duchy of the Sapphire Seas

Consisting of the provinces of Provence-Alpes-Côte d’Azur and Languedoc-Roussillon, along the Mediterranean Coast, this duchy is ruled by Lady Genève of House Fiona. Though strictly a monarchist, her pleasure-loving nature allows her to cast a blind eye at the many commoners who visit the pleasure resorts of Cannes, Monte Carlo, and Nice in search of summer sun, beautiful beaches, and the allure of the dice.

The Aquitaine

High Lord Rathsmere uses the Freehold of the Questing Blade, his holding in the south of France, as a training ground for Fiona knights from all over the changeling world. As an independent demesne, this duchy owes no allegiance to the other French holdings and draws many commoners, discontent with the tight laces of the nobility elsewhere. His realm includes the original French province of Aquitaine.